

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8
♥ A 7 3 2
♦ Q J 4
♣ J 10 7 3

♠ K 6 4 2

♥ J 8 5

♦ K 3 2

♣ A 6 2



♠ J 10
♥ 10 9 6 4
♦ 10 9 5
♣ K Q 8 5

♠ A Q 7 5 3

♥ K Q

♦ A 8 7 6

♣ 9 4

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 16 points SOUTH should open 1 ♠.

NORTH has 11 points and four ♠s. So even though he has a balanced hand, he jumps to 3 ♠, a Limit Raise.

SOUTH adds: her 16 plus NORTH's 11/12 equals a game, 4 ♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 2
 ♥ Q 2
 ♦ Q J 10 9 4 3
 ♣ 7 4 2

♠ A K Q 7

♥ 7 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ Q 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5 3

♥ K J 10 9 8 5

♦ 7

♣ A 10 8 6

♠ J 10 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ A K 6

♣ K J 3

SOUTH has the type of 5-card Major hand that many players would open 1NT. He has 17 points with most of them OUTSIDE the Major suit. But, many others would disagree so for this Deal SOUTH will open 1♠.

NORTH has 11 points and excellent (is that strong enough?) ♠ support. So she naturally makes a Limit Raise of 3♠.

SOUTH adds the points and ignores the fact that his ♠ suit is Jack high. He bids 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

Board 3

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 10 8 7 2
♥ A 6
♦ A 10 8
♣ Q 7 5 4

♠ A 6 4
♥ K 9 5 2
♦ 7 6 5 3
♣ A K



♠ Q J 9 3
♥ 7 4
♦ 9 4 2
♣ J 10 8 3

♠ K 5
♥ Q J 10 8 3
♦ K Q J
♣ 9 6 2

SOUTH has a minimum 1♥ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps.

NORTH also has opening hand strength, 14 points for him. He also has four of SOUTH's ♥s. He applies the "He who knows, goes" principle and bids 4♥.

IMPORTANT NOTE: Most experienced bridge pairs would not bid the hand quite this way, although they would arrive at the same contract. See some of the other BakerBridge lessons for more details.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 3
♥ 9 7 6 3 2
♦ 8 2
♣ A K Q 2

♠ K Q 9 2

♥ Q J

♦ Q 7 6 4

♣ J 8 4



♠ 5

♥ 10 8 4

♦ J 10 9 5

♣ 10 7 6 5 3

♠ A J 10 8 7 4

♥ A K 5

♦ A K 3

♣ 9

SOUTH has a powerful hand (21 points) with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1 ♠.

NORTH has an 11-point Limit Raise with four trumps. She jumps to 3 ♠.

SOUTH now knows that the partnership holds at least 32 points, perhaps 33. Since he can see that the opponents have no way to win the first two tricks he decides to bid the slam, 6 ♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8
♥ Q 10 9 2
♦ K 7 5 4
♣ 10 9 5

♠ J 10 9 4 3

♥ A 5 3

♦ 9

♣ K 8 6 3



♠ Q
♥ K J 8 4
♦ Q J 10 6 2
♣ Q 7 2

♠ A 7 6 5 2

♥ 7 6

♦ A 8 3

♣ A J 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

SOUTH has 14 points and opens 1 ♠, her 5-card Major.

NORTH could bid 3 ♠, a Limit Raise with his 11 points. But it is often a good idea, when you have five of the Major suit that partner opened with, to just go ahead and bid the game. So North should bid 4 ♠ here.

See the NOTE in Deal 13. When you use weaker 5-card support hands for your jump to game, you need to find another way to describe your opening-hand-strength type hands.